- Test both positive and negative cases. Every policy that allows an action should also include a denial test to verify boundaries.
- Seed entity graphs carefully. Create test fixtures that reflect production relationships so that policies are tested in realistic situations.
- Mirror the production schema. Running tests against the same schema version as production helps prevent subtle mismatches.
- Establish regressions as guardrails. Every bug fix is accompanied by a test to prevent it from reappearing.
- Automate in CI/CD. Policy tests run automatically with every pull request, and a failing test prevents deployment until the rule is fixed.

At ACME, this discipline minimized surprises in production and gave engineers the confidence to modify schemas, refine relationships, or add global guardrails without the fear of breaking existing access paths.

Testing provides more than confidence; it accelerates iteration. ACME's engineers can reliably modify schemas, improve relationship models, or add global constraints, knowing the test suite will catch any unintended effects before deployment.